

New Zealand Student Visa Checklist

A simple, student-friendly guide to help you prepare the documents commonly needed before applying for a New Zealand student visa.

Best used after you have chosen a course and are getting ready for your Offer of Place and visa application.

Course ready

Funds ready

Documents ready

Before you start

This checklist is a preparation guide, not immigration advice. Immigration New Zealand makes the final decision on every visa application. Always check the latest INZ requirements before you apply, and speak to a licensed immigration adviser if you need advice for your personal situation.

Visa readiness at a glance

Use these five steps to understand where you are in the process.

01

Choose your study pathway

Know the course, campus, start date, length and provider.

02

Secure your Offer of Place

You usually need this before applying for a student visa.

03

Prepare funds evidence

Show tuition, living costs and outward travel can be covered.

04

Check health and character

Medical, X-ray or police certificates may be required.

05

Apply online

Upload clear documents and allow enough processing time.

Recommended timing

Immigration New Zealand encourages international students to apply around 3 months before their intended travel date. Do not leave the visa application until the last minute.

Document checklist

Tick each item as you collect it. Requirements can vary depending on your age, country, course length and personal situation.

1. Identity documents

- ☐ Passport valid for at least 3 months after the date you plan to leave New Zealand.
- ☐ Clear scan of your passport bio-data page.
- ☐ Visa photo that meets New Zealand visa photo rules.
- ☐ Name change, birth or marriage documents if your details differ across documents.

2. Course and enrolment evidence

- ☐ Offer of Place from an approved New Zealand education provider.
- ☐ Course details: programme name, level, start date, end date, campus and fees.
- ☐ Tuition payment receipt, scholarship evidence, or proof you can pay the tuition fees.
- ☐ Academic transcripts, completion certificates and English test results if relevant.

3. Funds and financial evidence

- ☐ Living cost funds: generally NZD \$20,000 per year, or NZD \$1,667 per month for shorter tertiary, English language or other non-compulsory study.
- ☐ Bank statements showing account holder name and the last 3 months of transaction history.
- ☐ Fixed-term deposit, scholarship, education loan or provident fund evidence, if used.
- ☐ Explanation and supporting proof for large deposits or unclear source of funds.
- ☐ Evidence of funds for outward travel, or a return/onward ticket.

4. Sponsor or guarantor evidence, if used

- ☐ Sponsor sharing ID if you have an acceptable sponsor in New Zealand.
- ☐ Sponsor evidence such as recent bank statements, payslips or employment agreement.
- ☐ Completed Financial Undertaking for a Student form if a guarantor is supporting you.
- ☐ Evidence that sponsor or guarantor funds are genuine and available.

5. Health and insurance

- ☐ Medical and travel insurance acceptable to your education provider.
- ☐ Chest X-ray certificate if required for your country, travel history or length of stay.
- ☐ Medical examination if required. Health evidence usually must be recent when submitted.
- ☐ Any extra pregnancy or health-related evidence if it applies to you.

6. Character documents

- ☐ Police certificates if you are 17 or older and your total time in New Zealand will be 24 months or longer.
- ☐ Police certificates from countries you are a citizen of and countries where you spent more than 5 years since turning 17, if required.
- ☐ Certificates issued recently enough for INZ requirements.
- ☐ Certified English translations for any documents not in English.

Genuine student preparation

This is where many applications become stronger. Your documents should tell one clear story: why this course, why New Zealand and how you will support yourself.

7. Genuine intention and study plan

- ☐ Short study statement explaining why you chose this course and how it connects to your past study, work experience or career goals.
- ☐ Explanation for any study gaps, work gaps, previous visa refusals or changes in direction.
- ☐ Evidence of current employment, business, family, study or other ties outside New Zealand, if relevant.
- ☐ Updated CV or work history if it helps explain your pathway.
- ☐ English language evidence, if required by the course or useful for your profile.
- ☐ Clear answers that match your documents. Avoid conflicting dates, course names or funding details.

8. Special situation checks

- ☐ Under 18: accommodation statement from your education provider if required.
- ☐ Aged 16 or 17 and wanting work rights: parent/legal guardian and provider permission may be needed.
- ☐ Practical work experience: evidence that the work experience is a required part of the course.
- ☐ Family members: partner or children cannot be included in a Fee Paying Student Visa application, but may apply separately if eligible.

9. Final upload checks

- ☐ All scans are clear, complete and readable.
- ☐ Files are named clearly, for example: Passport, Offer of Place, Bank Statement, Tuition Receipt.
- ☐ Names and dates match across your passport, offer, academic records and financial documents.
- ☐ Any document not in English includes a certified English translation.
- ☐ Any agent or adviser help is declared where required.

Suggested preparation timeline

Use this as a general planning guide and adjust based on your intake date.

4-6 months before

Choose your course, check passport validity, start English testing if required, collect academic documents.

3 months before

Aim to have your Offer of Place, tuition plan, funds evidence and key documents ready for visa submission.

After visa approval

Confirm travel, accommodation, insurance, orientation dates and arrival documents.

Common mistakes to avoid

These are not refusal reasons in every case, but they often cause delays or make an application harder to assess.

Unclear funds

Large deposits with no explanation, funds held for a very short time, or unclear sponsor documents.

Weak study story

No clear reason for the course, provider, country choice or career pathway.

Mismatched details

Different names, dates, course names or fee amounts across documents.

Missing documents

Applying without the correct offer, tuition evidence, translations or financial proof.

Old certificates

Police, X-ray or medical documents that are outside required timeframes.

Assuming work rights

Work conditions depend on the visa granted. Always check the conditions on your visa.

How Enrollify can help

We help students understand their study options and prepare for the next step with more confidence.

Course and pathway support

- ☐ Help you compare suitable study pathways in New Zealand.
- ☐ Explain course levels, start dates, entry requirements and likely next steps.
- ☐ Help you prepare questions before applying to a provider.

Visa readiness support

- ☐ Help you understand what documents you may need to prepare.
- ☐ Help you organise your documents into a clear checklist.
- ☐ Refer you to a licensed immigration adviser where individual immigration advice is needed.

Ready to check your study options?

Speak with Enrollify about your course goals, entry requirements and visa preparation timeline.

www.enrollifyedu.com

Source note: Prepared using Immigration New Zealand student visa guidance available in June 2026, including the Fee Paying Student Visa, student fund requirements and study visa pages. Requirements, fees, processing times and evidence rules can change. Always check Immigration New Zealand before applying.